“I should operate. The injury hasn’t gone as deep as the bone, but I need to ensure the infection is all cleared out.” He wiped his face. “Dirt likely got into the wound. Olga said the women were forced by the Wehrmacht to dig tank traps against the Soviet army.”

Léa looked at the women: grandmothers, mothers, daughters, sisters, aunts. A week ago, they’d been digging trenches on a battlefield. Now, they were helping one another survive and not giving up hope.

She wondered if Lagerführer Klein had intended the opposite—expecting the women would look out for themselves and arrive near death. Is that why she’d enlisted Léa, because saving Russian civilians was beneath her? Without the money Rose received from Reinhardt, they wouldn’t be able to buy medical supplies. Maybe Rose was right; he hadn’t wanted more from her than friendship. With André here, Léa wanted to believe everything might work out. She, Rose, and Josef would do what needed to be done to save lives, proving that *fraternité* could be nurtured even during war.

“I’ll need your help with the operation,” he said quietly.

“Of course.” It was just the two of them, along with the women in the tent.

He touched her arm, clearly restraining the urge to pull her close. “You were extraordinary today. Thank you.”

Over Josef’s shoulder, Léa saw Nadiya watching.

“You must be exhausted,” he said heavily. “I’m sorry to ask you to do more.”

“Don’t be. I want to be here. You can’t do this on your own.”

“What would I do without you?” His finger touched her nose.

“You don’t have to worry about that because I’m not planning on going anywhere,” Léa said, grinning. “Except to the sick bay to get the Betabion for Nadiya. Can I bring anything else?”

Josef listed off a few items in response.

“We still have to write the report for Reinhardt. I will request that these women remain in Glashütte to work because they will require medical care over the next months. Go on and get what you need from the sick bay. We’ve still a long night ahead.”

She left the tent and took the steps down the platform to the street. The sun was beginning to sink behind the hills, the sky a honeycomb of gray